Ajay Dhage

Site Reliability Engineer | Senior DevOps Engineer | Platform Engineering
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing, automating and operating highly available cloud-native platforms on AWS, GCP and Azure. Currently an SRE at 66degrees managing GKE and Google Cloud environments for customers. Previously Technical Lead at Comviva Technologies, owning Kubernetes production platforms (45+ microservices, 200+ pods) processing 50M+ API transactions per day at about 5,000 TPS with 99.95% availability for 7 global enterprise clients. Strong in Kubernetes, Terraform, GitOps (ArgoCD), CI/CD, observability (Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, OpenTelemetry), SLI/SLO/error budgets, incident command and DevSecOps. Reduced MTTR by 35%, release cycles by 60%, cloud spend by 25% and alert noise by 40%.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, RDS, ALB, NLB, Route 53, CloudWatch, Lambda, SNS, SQS), Google Cloud Platform (GKE, Cloud Build, Pub/Sub, Cloud Monitoring, BigQuery, Cloud Run), Azure (AKS, Azure DevOps, Azure Monitor)

Containers and Orchestration: Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Google GKE, Azure AKS, OpenShift, Docker, Helm, Kustomize, HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler

CI/CD and GitOps: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Azure Pipelines, Google Cloud Build, ArgoCD, Argo Rollouts, FluxCD, Flagger, JFrog Artifactory

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation, Packer, Crossplane

Observability and Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager, ELK Stack, Datadog APM, Splunk, Dynatrace, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry, SLI, SLO, Error Budgets

Service Mesh and Networking: Istio, Linkerd, Envoy, Nginx Ingress, HAProxy, mTLS, TCP/IP, Load Balancing

Security and DevSecOps: IAM, RBAC, OPA Gatekeeper, Falco, Trivy, Snyk, SonarQube, HashiCorp Vault, AWS Secrets Manager, Cosign, SAST, DAST, Vulnerability Management

Streaming and Messaging: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, Google Pub/Sub, Event-Driven Architecture

Reliability Engineering: Incident Management, Root Cause Analysis, Postmortems, Capacity Planning, Disaster Recovery, High Availability, Chaos Engineering, Blue/Green Deployment, Canary Deployment, FinOps, On-Call Management

Incident and ITSM Tools: PagerDuty, ServiceNow, Jira, Confluence, Opsgenie

Programming and Databases: Python, Bash, Shell Scripting, Go (basic), Groovy, YAML, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Linux

AI and Automation: K8sGPT, OpenAI API integration, ML model observability

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Site Reliability Engineer

66degrees | Bengaluru, India | Aug 2026 - Present

- Manage and optimize cloud infrastructure on Google Cloud Platform (GCP) for customer environments.
- Build and operate scalable, highly available Kubernetes (GKE) environments.
- Automate infrastructure provisioning using Terraform and Python.
- Implement CI/CD pipelines, monitoring, alerting and observability solutions using Prometheus and Grafana.
- Troubleshoot production incidents and drive root cause analysis (RCA) to prevent recurrence.
- Improve platform reliability by applying SRE and DevOps best practices across customer workloads.
- Collaborate with customers and engineering teams to deliver resilient cloud solutions and continuous operational improvement.

Technical Lead - Platform Engineering and Site Reliability Engineering

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Oct 2024 - Jul 2026

Clients: UPS, E& (Emirates Telecom Group), KCA, KSA Telecom, MTN Zambia, Cell C, Vodafone Idea (VIL)

- Led and mentored a team of 3 DevOps/SRE engineers and collaborated with Product, QA and Operations to deliver zero-downtime releases for 7 global enterprise clients.
- Owned Kubernetes production clusters on EKS and GKE (45+ microservices, 200+ pods) processing about 5,000 TPS across dev, staging and production; maintained 99.95% SLA with sub-100ms p99 latency.
- Defined SLI/SLO/error budgets and Prometheus alerting rules; reduced MTTR by 35% and alert noise by 40% through runbook automation and threshold tuning.
- Led P0/P1 incident war-rooms and RCAs, including a critical UPS production rollback; delivered structured postmortems with corrective action plans in Jira and Confluence.
- Implemented Blue/Green and Canary deployments with Argo Rollouts and Flagger using SLO-based automated rollback; achieved zero failed production releases in 6 months.

- Designed multi-region HA/DR architecture with cross-region RDS and S3/GCS replication and automated failover; achieved RPO under 1 hour and RTO under 30 minutes.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning with Terraform modules and ArgoCD GitOps; eliminated configuration drift and reduced provisioning time by 70%.
- Built A/B experimentation infrastructure using Istio traffic splitting and Argo Rollouts with Prometheus SLO gates for safe ML feature rollouts.
- Deployed ML model observability with custom Prometheus exporters, Grafana dashboards and PagerDuty alerting for model latency, error rate and prediction drift.
- Owned Kafka pipeline reliability: consumer-lag alerting, KEDA autoscaling on Kafka offsets and exactly-once delivery at 5,000 TPS.
- Implemented DevSecOps pipeline with Trivy, Falco, OPA Gatekeeper and Snyk; achieved 100% policy-compliant deployments and a 65% reduction in CVE exposure.
- Optimized HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter and Cluster Autoscaler; right-sized 45 workloads and cut monthly cloud spend by 25% (about USD 18K per month).
- Integrated Datadog APM with PagerDuty on-call scheduling, reducing MTTA by 50%.
- Contributed to the effort to list the Ngage product on AWS Marketplace.

Senior Engineer - DevOps and Site Reliability Engineering

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Feb 2023 - Sep 2024

Clients: E& (Etisalat), MTN Zambia, Cell C, VIL, KSA Telecom

- Deployed and operated an omnichannel messaging platform (SMS, Email, Voice, WhatsApp, RCS, Chatbot) on EKS using Helm and Docker, processing 50M+ API transactions per day with multi-AZ high availability and sub-100ms p99 latency targets.
- Built and operated GKE and EKS clusters with Workload Identity, Cluster Autoscaler and distributed tracing across AWS and GCP.
- Implemented Kafka consumer-lag-based autoscaling with KEDA for billing, usage and transaction streams for Cell C and KSA Telecom.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Google Cloud Build and GitLab CI, including parallel testing, JFrog Artifactory and Trivy/Snyk scanning; reduced release cycles by 60%.
- Deployed a centralized observability stack with Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Alertmanager, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry and Datadog APM.
- Implemented Istio and Linkerd service mesh (mTLS, circuit breaking, traffic shifting); reduced inter-service latency by 15%.
- Integrated HashiCorp Vault and AWS Secrets Manager, eliminating hardcoded credentials across 45+ microservices.
- Authored 20+ reusable Terraform modules for VPC, EKS, GKE, RDS and IAM across 3 cloud accounts with Sentinel governance policies.
- Managed PagerDuty schedules and ServiceNow incidents for E& and VIL; reduced MTTR from 45 to 29 minutes over 18 months.
- Integrated K8sGPT with a local AI backend to diagnose and resolve Kubernetes issues, and developed a generative AI chatbot using OpenAI GPT-3.5.

Engineer - Software Development and DevOps

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Sep 2021 - Jan 2023

Clients: VIL, KCA, KSA Telecom

- Developed containerized microservices (Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs) on Kubernetes; authored Dockerfiles, Helm charts and GitHub Actions pipelines.
- Built automated unit, integration and regression testing in CI with SonarQube quality gates; reduced production defects by 40%.
- Supported migration from a monolith to microservices on EKS/GKE for KSA Telecom, managing AWS and GCP resources with Terraform.
- Configured Prometheus alerts and Grafana dashboards for latency, error rate and resource utilization; used GCP Stackdriver for GKE visibility.
- Participated in on-call rotations, incident triage, postmortems and runbook development.

CMS Web Developer

Simplotel Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Nov 2020 - Jul 2021

- Built and optimized CMS-based websites for 25+ hospitality brands; improved page load speed by 30% through caching and frontend tuning.
- Integrated REST APIs and delivered SEO and UI/UX improvements in Agile/Scrum sprints using Git.

KEY PROJECTS

Real-Time High-Throughput Platform (E&, MTN Zambia, VIL): EKS, GKE, Kafka, Istio, ArgoCD, KEDA. Operated a platform handling 50M+ API transactions per day with sub-100ms latency across AWS and GCP; KEDA lag-based autoscaling absorbed burst traffic without SLO breach.

Multi-Region HA/DR Platform: AWS, GCP, Route 53, RDS, Terraform. Active-passive architecture with health-check failover and cross-region replication; RPO under 1 hour and RTO under 30 minutes validated through chaos engineering

drills using AWS FIS.

GitOps Migration and Canary Deployments: ArgoCD, Argo Rollouts, Flagger, Helm, Kustomize. Migrated 45+ microservices from imperative kubectl to GitOps with automated rollback on error-rate breach.

A/B Experimentation and ML Model Reliability: Istio, Argo Rollouts, Prometheus, Grafana, Vertex AI. Built traffic-split experimentation, shadow traffic validation and ML endpoint observability.

Centralized Observability Platform: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Datadog, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry, PagerDuty. Unified metrics, logs, traces and on-call across 45+ microservices.

Kubernetes Autoscaling and Cost Optimization: HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Spot Instances. Reduced monthly cloud spend by 25% while maintaining SLOs.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Maintained 99.95% SLA on a 5,000 TPS, 45-microservice production platform serving 7 global enterprise clients.
- Reduced MTTR by 35% (45 to 29 minutes) and MTTA by 50%.
- Reduced release cycles by 60% and infrastructure provisioning time by 70%.
- Cut cloud costs by 25% (about USD 18K per month) and CVE exposure by 65%.
- Achieved zero failed production releases over 6 months with GitOps and SLO-gated rollback.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Electronics and Communications Engineering
Guru Nanak Dev Engineering College, Bidar, Karnataka, India | 2016 - 2020

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Implement Frameworks the DevOps Way
- Bash Scripting and Shell Programming
- AI From the Data Center to the Edge, Intel Architecture
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA), Linux Foundation: in progress
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03): in progress
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate: in progress

PUBLICATIONS

- Intel Edison Kit and IoT Based Smart Health Monitoring System (ISBN recognised paper)
- Overdose Detection and Monitoring

LANGUAGES

English, Hindi, Kannada, Marathi (Professional Working Proficiency)